



NEW FAMILY JOURNEY MAP

A tool for seeing your unit through the eyes of a new family and identifying opportunities to strengthen belonging.

Purpose

The New Family Journey Map helps leaders evaluate the experiences a new family has during their first few months in the unit. The goal is not to improve everything at once. The goal is to identify one experience that could help a new family feel more welcomed, connected, and included.

Quick Start Guide

Think about the last family that joined your unit. Walk through their experience from first contact to becoming an active member.

Then ask four belonging questions:

1. **What message did your unit's first contact with this family communicate that encouraged them to register for Scouting?**

Think about: Join Night, Open House, BeAScout inquiry, Friend invitation, First communication

What might have encouraged this family to take the next step?

2. **What happened at their first meeting?**

Imagine experiencing the meeting for the first time.

Was it easy to know: Where to go? Who to talk to? What was happening? What happens next?

Did they feel welcomed?

3. **When did they begin feeling involved?**

Think about the family's first few weeks. When did they: Learn names? Make connections? Participate? Feel included?

Or did they?

4. **How does the unit help families feel they belong?**

What experiences communicate:

"We're glad you're here!" - rather than – ***"Figure it out and catch up."***

Important Reminders

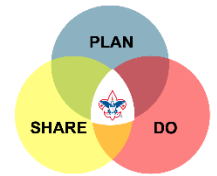
The goal is not simply registration.

The goal is not simply attendance,

The goal is not simply communication.

The goal is belonging.

Kettle Country District New Family Journey Map



Program Assessment Connection

Stage of the Journey	What does the family experience?	What helps them feel connected?	One opportunity to strengthen belonging
First Contact			
First Meeting			
First Month			
First Three Months			

Belonging Reflection

If you were a brand-new parent visiting your unit for the first time, where might you feel uncertain?

What experiences help a family move from being a visitor to feeling like they belong?

Are there places in the journey where a family could quietly drift away? _____

One Next Step

One experience we could improve for new families: _____

Who will help strengthen that experience? _____

One action we will take before our next committee meeting: _____

Family Journey Map Takeaway:

Families begin deciding whether they belong long before they decide whether they will stay.